Vopak

South Africa liquid fuels market outlook

Demand, supply and routes — implications for Vopak

Durban and Lesedi | Market-sizing framework

11 October 2026

Planning estimates and illustrative capture. Customer access and usable capacity remain to be established.

Photo source: Royal Vopak | Terminal Durban | vopak.com



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South Africa's large fuel market relies on substantial imports

21.0bn L

Estimated demand, 2025

8.9bn petrol and 12.1bn diesel

5.8bn L

Domestic production assumption

National planning baseline

16.7bn L

Gross import requirement

Broadly matches recorded imports

A substantial demand base

Road transport is the largest use. Mining, agriculture, manufacturing and power also contribute.

Demand has eased from 21.9bn litres in 2023 to an estimated 21.0bn in 2025.

Durban connects imports to inland customers

Durban customs recorded 13.16bn litres of imports in 2025. The Durban–Lesedi route provides access to inland demand, subject to customer and logistics access.

South Africa has an established import market serving a large national fuel requirement.

Department national sales; SARS 2025 trade; analytical workbook v02. 2025 demand is estimated; 5.8bn L production is a planning assumption. Gross import need includes exports and assumes no stock change.

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Changes in demand, domestic supply and import routes could reduce flows through Durban

Complication	Driver	What changes for fuel demand and Durban flows
1 Demand	Sector activity | p5	Mining, manufacturing and agriculture drive equipment and freight demand along different growth paths.
	Eskom recovery | p6	Reliable electricity reduces peaking and backup diesel at utilities, mines, factories and farms.
	Road-to-rail | p7	Freight shifted from trucks reduces road diesel use; net savings depend on rail traction.
	Vehicle efficiency | p8	Lower fuel consumption per kilometre reduces demand at a given level of road activity.
2 Domestic supply	Refinery output and restarts | p9	Higher production displaces imports; outages or lower output increase import dependence.
3 Import routes	Ports and inland connections | p10	Matola competes for inland supply. Assess Walvis Bay, pipeline access and delivered cost; Walvis Bay diversion is unquantified.

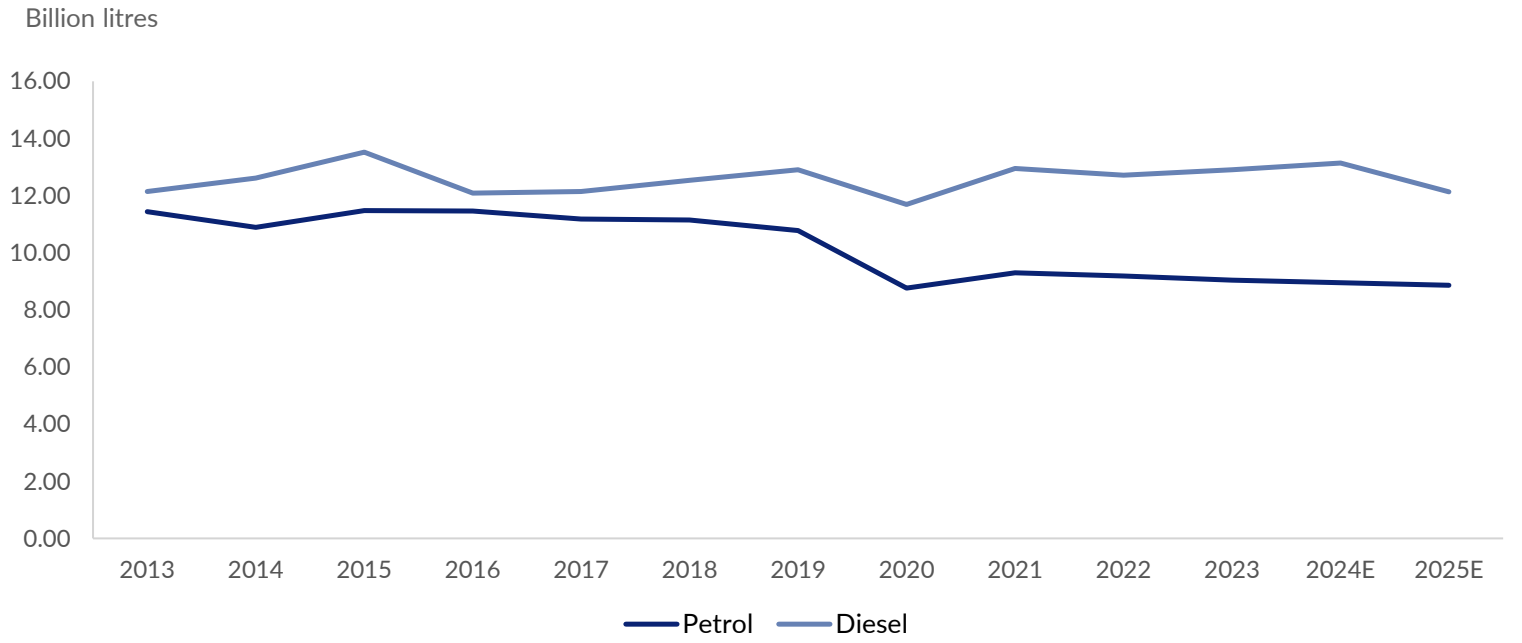
A large national import market does not automatically translate into growth for Vopak.

Demand baseline: p4. Driver evidence: pp5–10. Stats SA; Eskom Integrated Report 2025 p141; Sasol, Glencore, Galp and Petromoc disclosures; naamsa vehicle sales.

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South Africa's estimated 21bn-litre fuel market is dominated by road demand

Petrol and diesel demand, 2013–2025



2025 estimated demand

Petrol road 8.59 | Freight 4.82

Other road diesel 1.61

Mining 1.41 | Agriculture 1.13

Power 1.08 | Manufacturing 0.17

Other petrol 0.27 | Other diesel 1.91

All values: bn litres. Allocations are estimates; manufacturing is an industry residual.

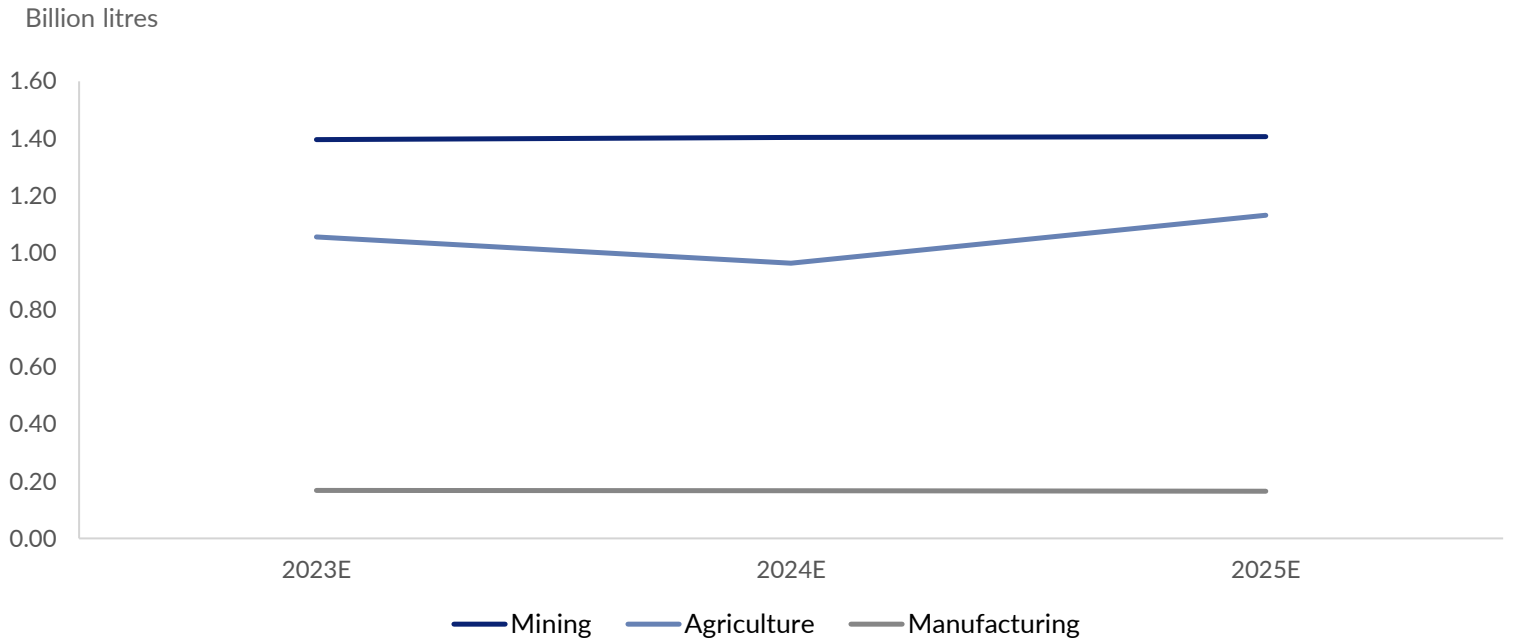
Demand is estimated at 20.99bn litres in 2025; road uses account for most allocated demand.

Department annual sales, 2013–2023. Estimated 2024–2025: analytical workbook v02. The Department series is used consistently. Segment split: analytical workbook v02, Segments. Displayed figures rounded; other diesel remains unallocated.

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Agricultural fuel demand rebounds while mining and manufacturing remain broadly flat

Estimated sector diesel demand



Estimated diesel use

Mining: 1.40 → 1.41bn L

Agriculture: 1.06 → 1.13bn L

Manufacturing: about 0.17bn L

Manufacturing covers the energy-balance industry residual, not a complete industrial census.

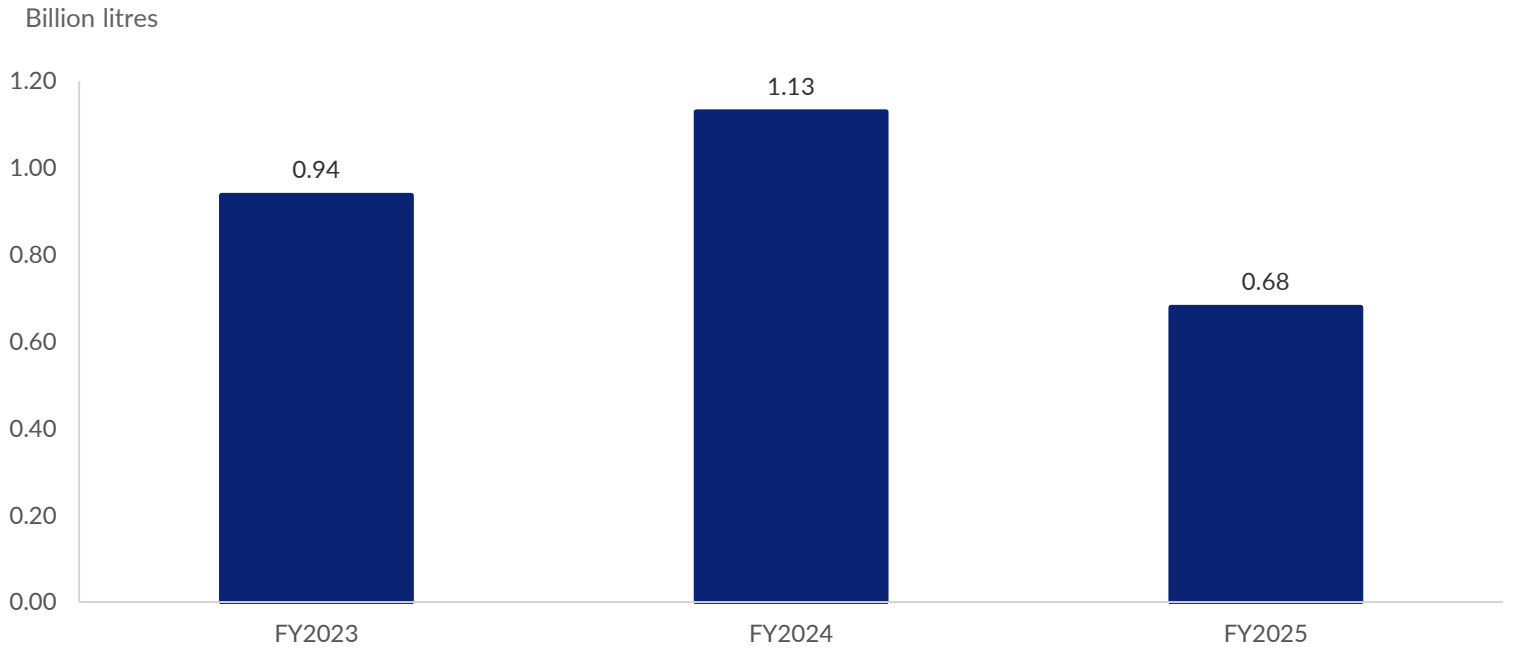
Sector activity produces different demand paths; applying one GDP growth rate would hide these differences.

Stats SA mining/manufacturing indices and agriculture real GVA; mean 2018–2021 fuel intensity. Sector diesel values after 2021 are estimates.

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Eskom’s fuel use fell by 40% in FY2025 as electricity supply improved

Eskom diesel and kerosene use



Power fuel use

Eskom: 1.130bn L in FY2024 → 0.679bn L in FY2025 (diesel + kerosene).

2025 utility + private power estimate: 1.08bn L, including 0.20bn L assumed private backup.

IPP conversion and fiscal-year proxies are estimates; private use is not measured by Eskom.

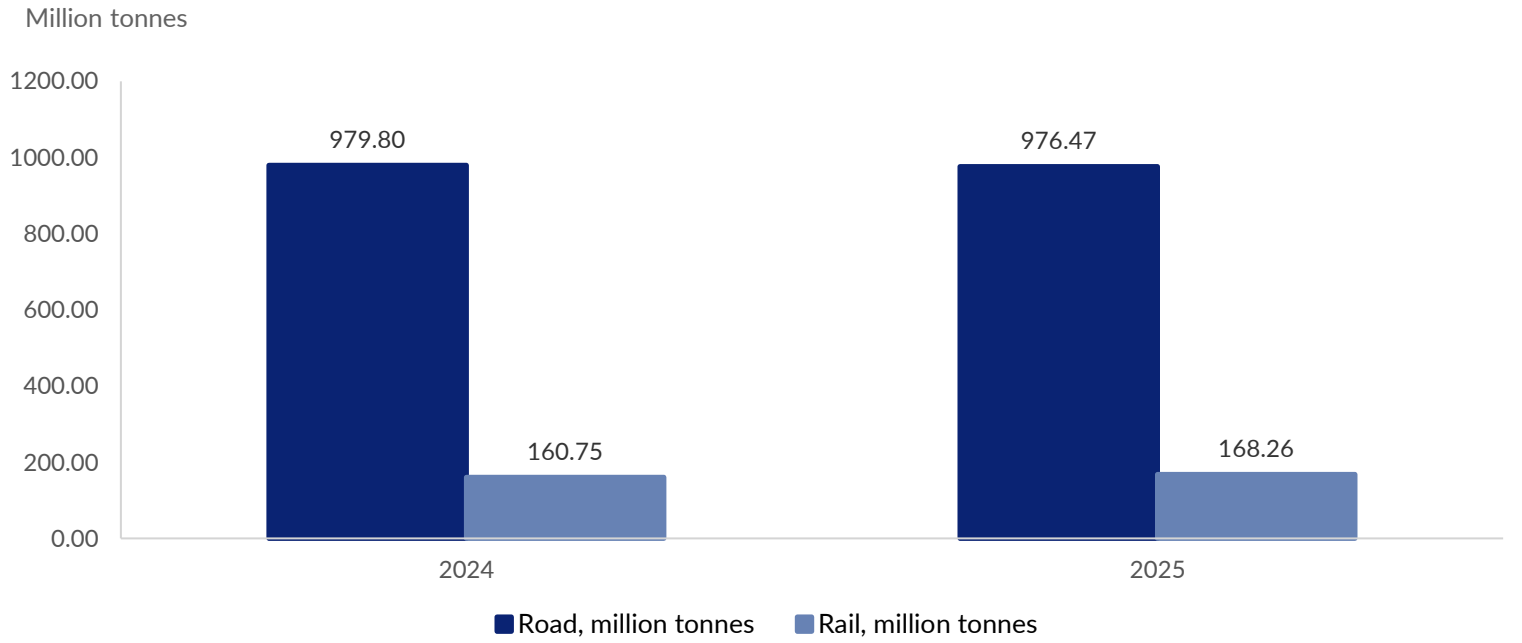
Improved electricity supply reduces peaking and backup fuel use; the private-backup contribution remains estimated.

Eskom Integrated Report 2025, p141. Fiscal years end in March. Reported series includes diesel and kerosene; private backup consumption is outside this series. Analytical workbook v02, Segments: IPP conversion and private-backup assumptions.

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Rail volumes are recovering, creating scope to reduce road diesel use

Reported road and rail freight



Recovery and displacement

Rail: 160.7m tonnes in 2024 to 168.3m in 2025. Road: 979.8m to 976.5m tonnes.

A shift of mining, agricultural and manufactured goods to rail can reduce truck fuel use.

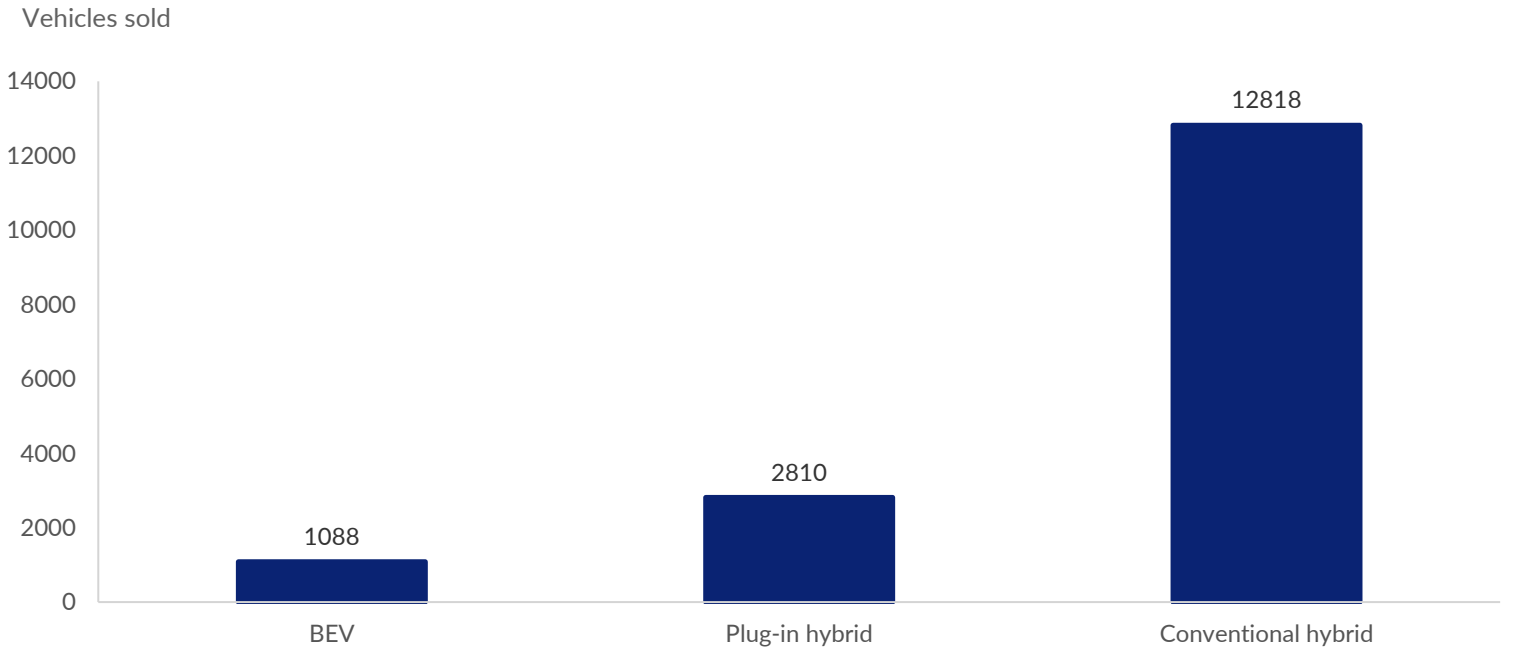
Rail growth alone does not prove road displacement; distance, cargo and traction mix matter.

Road remains the dominant freight mode; sustained rail recovery could change the diesel required to move goods.

Stats SA P7162 December 2025 p7; all reported freight. Analytical workbook v02, Evidence.

Hybrids dominate electrified new-vehicle sales; fleet fuel savings emerge as vehicles turn over

Electrified vehicle sales, 2025



Different fuel-use effects

BEV: 1,088 sales, or 0.18% of all new vehicles.

PHEVs and conventional hybrids still consume fuel; savings depend on usage.

New sales are not fleet penetration. Efficiency and mileage must be modelled separately.

The model's fuel-efficiency path is a planning assumption; new-vehicle sales alone do not quantify national fuel savings.

naamsa all-market sales 2025; master workbook Vehicle history S31:S36; evidence retained in market story v27 p11. Analytical workbook v02: efficiency is a planning assumption; avoid double-counting hybrid savings.

Changes in refinery output alter the volume that imports must supply

Domestic supply	Reported evidence	Implication for imports
Secunda	Refined-products output: 29.1m barrels in FY2024; 27.6m in FY2025; 30.6m in FY2026	Operating recovery can increase domestic supply; petrol and diesel yields determine import displacement.
Natref	Sasol-reported output: 17.8m barrels in FY2024; 14.7m in FY2025; 25.8m in FY2026	FY2026 includes above-share production, so the latest reported change cannot be treated as a like-for-like change in whole-plant output.
Astron	Reported refined products: 166,204 billion Btu in 2024; 164,365 billion Btu in 2025	Output and product mix affect supply; energy units require conversion before comparison with customs litres.
SAPREF and PetroSA	No refining contribution included in the 2025 production assessment	Restored refining would displace imports only when plants produce saleable products. Terminal handling is not refinery output.

The 5.8bn-litre 2025 petrol/diesel baseline is a planning assumption; these differently scoped plant disclosures do not sum directly to it.

Sasol production metrics FY2025 and FY2026; Glencore annual reports 2024 and 2025; 2025 plant assessment. Fiscal and calendar periods and reporting scopes differ. Product yields and reporting scopes require reconciliation to the 5.8bn-litre planning baseline.

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Durban's inland share depends on competing gateways and reliable onward connections

Supply route	Evidence available	Implication for addressable flows
Durban and other SA ports	Durban customs: 13.16bn L of petrol/diesel imports in 2025	Allocate national imports across gateways before assessing inland customer reach.
Durban–NMPP–Lesedi	Existing coastal-to-inland connection; customer and product access remain to be established	Pipeline, receipt and dispatch constraints determine the flows Vopak can serve.
Matola infrastructure	Galp/IPG: 60,000m³ petrol/diesel storage; Petromoc: 390,000m³ across liquid fuels	Do not add potentially overlapping capacities or equate tankage with annual SA deliveries.
Observed Mozambique route	Komatipoort recorded imports: 0.303bn L in 2022 → 0.086bn L in 2025	Observed cross-border flows provide a firmer volume anchor than storage capacity.
Walvis Bay alternative	Comparable delivered-cost, access and SA flow evidence is not established in this review	Retain as a route to assess; no quantified diversion or customer capture is assigned.

Compare the same product and inland destination across routes; Matola and Walvis Bay affect gateway share, not national demand.

SARS customs 2022/2025; Galp Matola commissioning, 3 December 2020; Petromoc logistics; existing Durban–Lesedi corridor evidence in market-sizing workbook. Walvis Bay diversion is unquantified; comparable delivered-cost evidence remains open.

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How the national fuel market translates into Vopak's addressable volume

Sizing step	Basis for the calculation	Market measure
1 **National demand**	Petrol and diesel by end use: road, mining, manufacturing, agriculture and power. Apply activity, rail and efficiency drivers.	21.0bn L in 2025 Estimated demand
2 **Import requirement**	Demand − domestic production + exports + stock build (or − stock draw).	16.7bn L in 2025 Gross import need
3 **Ports and inland routes**	Allocate imports across ports; assess pipeline, road and rail connections. Compare Durban with Matola and potential Walvis Bay routes.	Supply pool by catchment Route shares to establish
4 **Addressable market**	Size product and customer flows Durban and Lesedi can each serve, by catchment, logistics access and competing supply. Reconcile shared flows.	Addressable volume By site, product and customer
5 **Achievable capture**	Establish current Vopak throughput, volumes retained and additional customer volumes it can win. Assess competition and contracts; count shared fuel once.	Current + incremental capture By site and customer
6 **Capacity and investment**	Compare captured throughput with usable tanks, stock turns, receipt and dispatch capacity; identify the incremental constraint.	Capacity shortfall Basis for investment

Steps 4–5 size Vopak's opportunity: addressable customer flows, then achievable capture.

Framework: analytical workbook v02 and market-sizing workbook. Gateway shares and customer access require validation. Walvis Bay is a route to assess; no diversion volume is assigned. Stock build increases import need; stock draw reduces it.

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Substantial imports sustain the market, while customer capture determines Vopak's expansion

16.6bn L

2030 national imports

Base-case imports across all gateways. Activity growth broadly offsets power, rail and efficiency reductions; domestic production stays at 5.8bn litres.

2.63bn L

Illustrative Durban capture

Assumes 20% of Durban's 2025 import pool. Includes 1.32bn litres onward through Lesedi within the same fuel flow.

Illustrative share; no explicit deduction for Matola or Walvis Bay diversion.

Expansion follows secured incremental flow

The illustrative flow fits the preliminary working-tank calculation.

Secure additional customer volumes, establish usable capacity, and identify the constraint that investment would solve.

Invest where secured additional volumes create a demonstrated capacity shortfall.

Analytical workbook v02 base scenario; market-sizing workbook and working-capacity assessment. Capture is illustrative; Lesedi is included within Durban flow. Contracted share, product balance and usable capacity remain to be established.

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Thank you

South Africa fuel market and Vopak opportunity

Discussion

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Photo source: Royal Vopak | Terminal Durban | vopak.com

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